

Parent Co-Regulation & Emotional Burnout Reflection Journal

Compassion Fatigue Prevention & Nervous System Reset | Framework: Polyvagal Co-Regulation Science & Mindful Parenting

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Clinical Resource Packet

CHILD'S NAME	AGE / GRADE	DATE	COMPLETED BY

Weekly Parent Regulation Audit & Decompression Prompts	
CO-REGULATION CHECKPOINT	SELF-REFLECTION PROMPTS & DAILY RESET PRACTICE
1. Identifying My Triggers	What specific child behavior pushes me into fight-or-flight immediately? (e.g. screaming in public, ignoring my voice, sibling hitting).
2. My Physical Early Warnings	Where do I feel stress in my own body before I yell? (Clenched jaw, tight shoulders, shallow breathing, burning stomach).
3. The 3-Breath Circuit Breaker	Before responding to a meltdown: Stop. Drop shoulders. Exhale twice as long as the inhale (triggers parasympathetic vagal brake). Then speak in a lower pitch.
4. Replenishing My Own Energy	What is 1 micro-restoration activity I can do for 10 minutes today without feeling guilty? (Quiet tea, walk outside, music, sitting in silence).

Remember: You cannot co-regulate a dysregulated child with a dysregulated nervous system. Regulating yourself first is not selfish—it is an essential clinical intervention.